

Before

«ContactName»

«CompanyName»

«Address»

«Address2»

«City», «State» «Zip4»

January 2010/Tevet 5771

Dear «Salu»,

1 Your support during 2010 is greatly appreciated. Chabad _____ continues to be the premier provider of opportunities for Jewish Education and Experience to all Jews in-town regardless of affiliation or background. We can't do it without you and we are grateful for your support! **2**

3 Hebrew School, 80 children in Camp Gan Izzy, 400+ adults at various classes at the Jewish Academy, 1000+ at holiday events including, High Holidays, Martinis and Mitzvahs, Menorah Lightings, Passover Seders, Lag Ba'omer BBQ, Shavout All night Torah Study Marathon and Shavout Children's Ice Cream Party! On the financial side we raised over \$000,000 from 495 donors like you! **4**

5 We have listed your contribution activity below. If you need any additional assistance please call our office at xxx-xxx-xxxx and ask for _____. On behalf of all the people we have reached through our various programs and activities, thank you.

Donation Details -----

Date	Method	Number	Amount	Receipt #	Purpose
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6 «MultiLine»

*Total ****«TotalAmount»*** -----

No goods or services were provided in whole or in part for the contributions listed above other than intangible religious benefits. Tax ID Number:

7 With warm personal regards, [image: Description: signature-blue]

8 Ps. We have enclosed an envelope for a future contribution!

1. Try for something a bit more exciting. A better lead would make the letter seem less of a standard form letter and more heartfelt and genuine.
2. A very good job letting the donor know that it can't be done without them.
3. A few issues with this paragraph.
 - a. Information overload.
 - b. Could do a better job of incorporating the donor. It just finished saying that it could not be done without the donor and then you toot your own horn. At the very least it could say: Together we accomplished..
4. This is positive. It conveys the donor made a wise decision in donating since so many other people did as well. People like safety in numbers and it shows you have a strong following.

Continued below....

5. Having a number and name of person to call is very good. Shows you take them seriously.
6. A better idea might be to put the receipt on the reverse side or on separate piece of paper. You want the letter to be more genuine and less form - this is an easy way to do that.
7. It should be signed by hand at the very least and if possible a handwritten post-it with a personal message as well.
8. This is hotly debated in professional fundraising circles. Might want to ask a couple of close donors what their thoughts are. It could be a put off to some to get a 'soft ask' after just giving.
9. Use a serif font for printed letters – likes Times New Roman and the like.

After

1. This is something different; the donor is probably thinking this letter is not going to be about him - which will turn into a pleasant surprise.
2. You need to put the donor front and center, which these next two paragraphs do.
3. It is best to write a more concrete example of what his gift will go to - but this is fine as well for the interim. You can follow up later with something more definitive

Continued below

Dear <First name>,

- 1 Shofar factory, Menorah lighting, 33 Children in the preschool – the list goes on.
- 2 The common denominator in all these programs is you. Without your steadfast support none of this would have been able to happen. We consider you as one of our pillars and lean on you for continued inspiration and growth.

You provide the tools for a lifetime of Jewish experiences - from the preschool and Gan Izzy to the Jewish Academy and holiday programming - ensuring the Jewish community remains vibrant and thriving.

- 3 Thank you for gift in support of Jewish life at Chabad of _____. Your gift is already inspiring the next generation, allowing us to provide a top notch Jewish education and experiences for all Jews regardless of background and affiliation.

- 4 I look forward to sharing with you the many smiles your gift will make possible in our upcoming newsletter. If you have any questions please don't hesitate to call Danny at
- 5 (xxx) xxx-xxxx

Thank you so very much for planting the seeds of Judaism in _____

Rabbi_____

Director

- 6 P.s. 2012 was a fantastic year – You can head over to www._____.com to see your impact over the past year. There is a ton going on!

4. Let them know the next time they will hear from you - and about their gift.
5. The contact paragraph was kept. It is good to provide a real person for them to contact.
6. In the P.s. you can let them know off all things that happened over the past year without giving them information overload.
7. The font used is Palatino, which is a nice and clear serif font. The font size is 12 which is the recommended size.